uFTi user manual: iPhone

Understanding family tree information

Oughtibridge Ltd

Status: **Beta**

© 2026 Oughtibridge Ltd
This publication is available at https://docs.ufti.com/iphone/Alpha-1/

Contents

Quick Start ... 3
- Add your first person ... 3
- Look around ... 4
- Say where you found it ... 6
- Keep it safe ... 7
- What next ... 8

Five things to know ... 9
Work with your tree ... 10
- The screens of the app ... 10
- Find a person ... 16
- See a family tree ... 18
- See the events of a person ... 20
- Look at the sources of a fact ... 22
- Add another person ... 25
- Change a person ... 27
- Add a family with children ... 28
- Add a note to a person ... 31
- The Photos buttons ... 32
- Choose how the app looks ... 33
- A page says no person is selected ... 34

Bring in, share and keep safe ... 36
- Your workspace and its files ... 36
- Open a family tree file ... 37
- Remove a tree from the list ... 39
- Opened files and copies ... 39
- Which file to send ... 40

Glossary ... 41

Quick Start

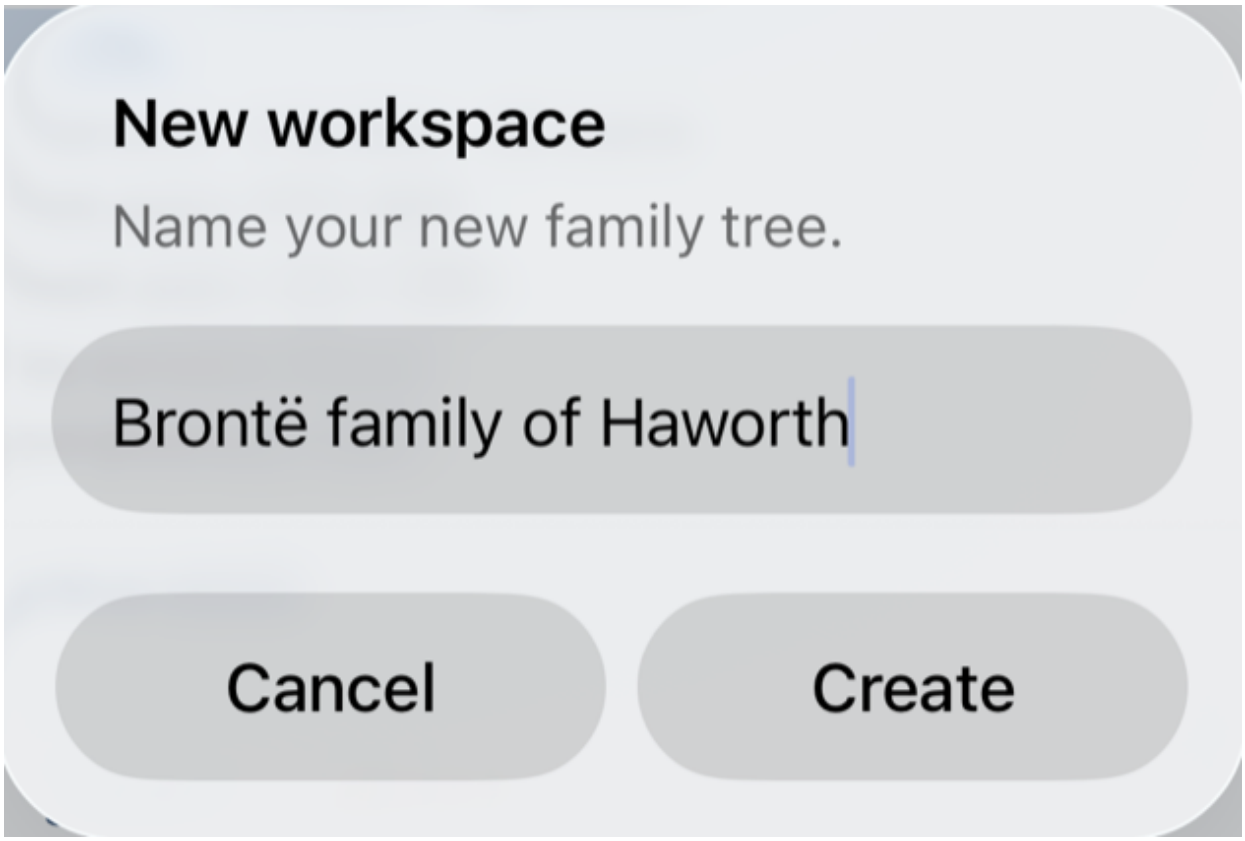
Six short pages that take you from opening uFTi to your first person, with its source and a copy.

This takes about ten minutes. Each page has a few steps. Do them in order.

Add your first person

Make your own workspace and add yourself, or someone you know well.

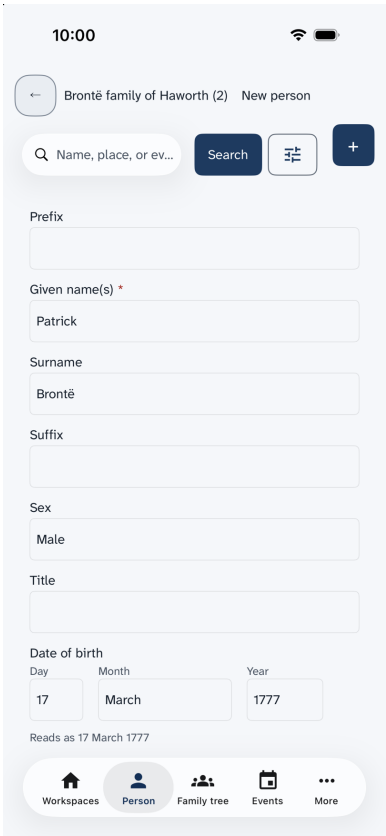
1. On **Workspaces**, choose **Create workspace**.
   A small box named New workspace opens. It starts with a name already in the box.



2. Type a name for your tree, such as `My family`, in place of the name that is there.
3. Choose **Create**.
   The **New person** form opens.
4. Type a first name in **Given name(s)**. Type a last name in **Surname**.
   Start with yourself, or someone you know well. Only the first name is needed. If you know the birth date, type it too.

5. Scroll down and choose **Save**.
   The page for that person opens.

That is your first person. uFTi saves your work as you go.



Next: Look around (page 4).

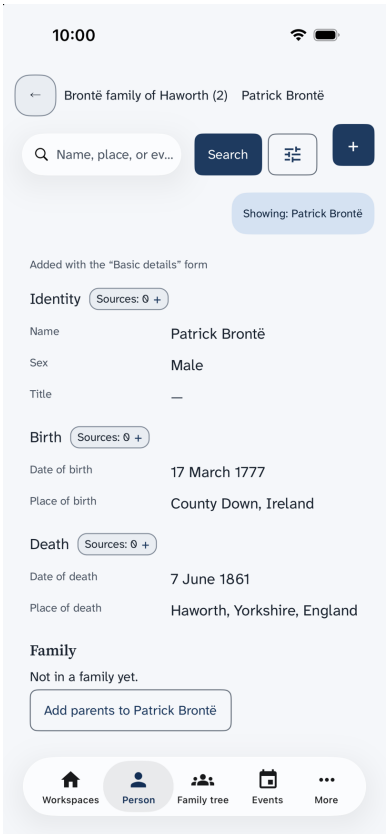
Look around

See what the five places in the bar and the search box do for the person you added.

Add a person first.

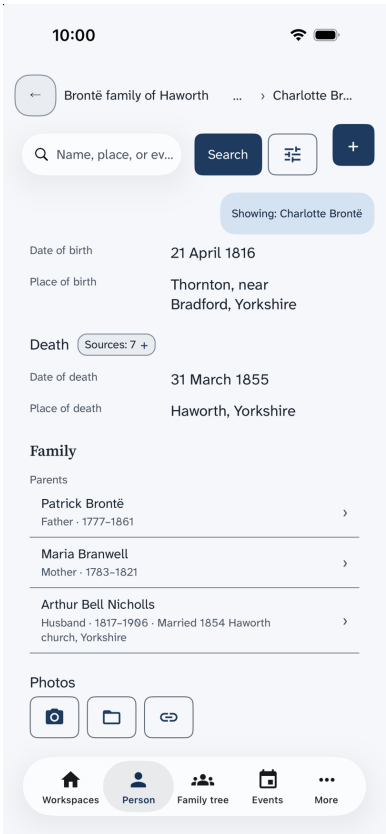
The bar along the bottom of the screen shows the main places. Most of them show the person you are looking at.

1. Choose **Person**.
   It shows that person's page.



2. Choose **Events**.
   It lists what happened in that person's life, such as a birth. Each one is a fact.
3. Choose **Family tree**.
   It draws a tree of that person, with parents above and children below.
4. Choose **More**.
   It lists **Notes** and some other places. They are for later.
5. Type a few letters of a name in the search box, then choose **Search**.
   The results are the only list of people. Choose a card to open that person.

To go back one screen, choose the back arrow at the top left.



Next: Say where you found it (page 6).

Say where you found it

Add a source to a fact, so you always know why you believe it.

Open the page of a person who has a birth date.

To find a person, type their name in the search box and choose **Search**. Then choose the card with their name.

1. Choose the small chip beside **Birth**.
   It shows a number and a plus sign, such as `0 +`.

   A screen named **Sources** opens.
2. Choose **Add source**, then **Add a new source**.
3. In **Title**, type where you know this from.
   For example, `My birth certificate` or `Mum told me`. Only this box is needed.
4. Choose **Save source**.
5. Choose **Done**, then **Done** again.
   The number on the chip goes up by one.

The fact now has a source. Later, when two records disagree, this is how you will know what to believe.

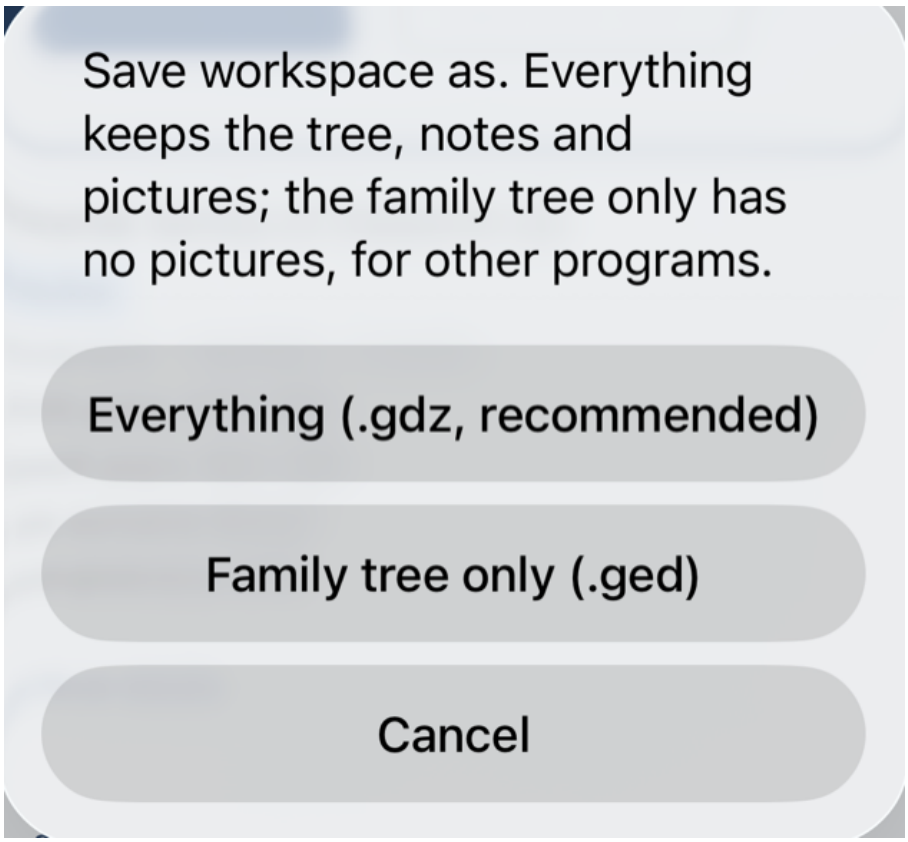
Next: Keep it safe (page 7).

Keep it safe

Save a copy of your tree as a file, and keep it somewhere else too.

1. Open **Workspaces**.
2. On the card for your tree, choose **Save as...**.

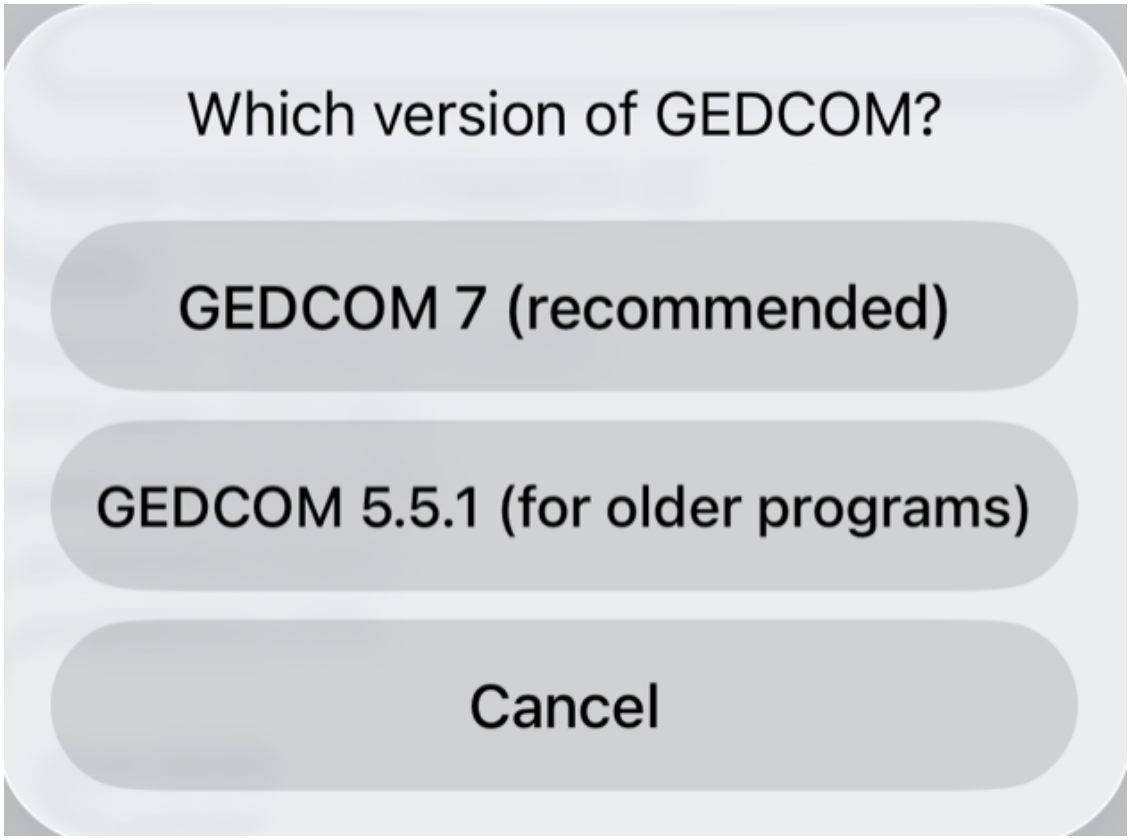
   A small box opens. It starts with the words Save workspace as and asks how to save your tree.



3. Choose how to save your tree.

   - **Everything (.gdz, recommended)** saves everything in one file, with its pictures. Choose this one.
   - **Family tree only (.ged)** saves your tree as a family tree file, without pictures. Use it only for a program that cannot read GEDZIP. If asked which version, choose GEDCOM 7 unless that program is old.

   A second box asks Which version of GEDCOM?.



4. In the Files screen, choose where to put the file, then choose **Save**.

You now have a copy. Make a new one after you add a lot. Keep one off your device too.

> If you opened a file from another program, uFTi keeps its own copy. The file you chose does not change.

Next: What next (page 8).

What next

You have a tree, a person, a fact with its source and a copy, so choose where to go from here.

Well done. What do you want to do now?

- Record more of what you have found. Say where you found it (page 6) shows how.
- Learn the ideas behind it all. Read Five things to know (page 9). It takes two minutes.

Five things to know

The five ideas behind uFTi, in two minutes.

A workspace is one family tree

You can have more than one. Each shows as a card on the **Workspaces** screen. Make a new workspace for each tree.

People and families

Add a person for each relative. A family joins a couple. uFTi draws a tree from your families. Choose **Family** to see it.

Facts and sources

A fact is something you record, such as a birth with its date. A source is where you found it. It can be a certificate, a census page, or what someone told you. A small chip beside each heading on a person's page counts the sources. Choose the chip to add one. Then you will always know why you believe a fact.

Saving and copies

uFTi saves your work as you go. To keep a copy, choose **Save as...** on your workspace's card. Keep the file somewhere else too. Do it again after a big session.

Getting help

Look in this guide when you are stuck. Use its search box, and type the words you would say. Practise in a workspace you make for the purpose.

Work with your tree

Find people, add people and families, read their events and sources, and write notes.

This chapter is for everything you do once a tree is open. It starts with a picture of every screen. Then it shows how to find a person, how to read what the app knows about them, and how to add more. Each page has a few steps and a picture of the result.

The pictures use one small tree: the family of Patrick Brontë of Haworth, a village in Yorkshire. You can build it yourself, a little at a time, as you read.

The screens of the app

What each place in the bar along the bottom shows, and what the More list holds, with a picture of each screen.

The bar along the bottom

The bar stays at the bottom of every screen. It has five places. Some show your whole tree. Others show one person, the person named in the chip that starts with **Showing**. The chip is empty until you open someone.

Table 1. The places in the bar and what they show

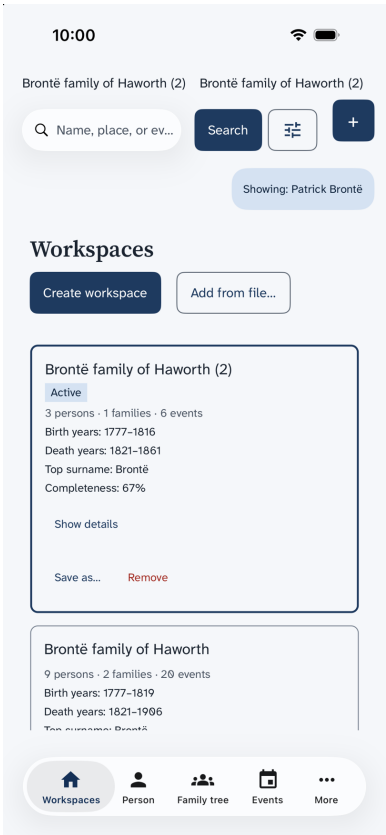
Place	What it shows	Needs a person
Workspaces	Your family trees, one card for each.	No
Person	The page of one person.	Yes
Family tree	A drawing of the person with parents, partners and children.	Yes
Events	The things that happened in that person's life.	Yes
More	A list of other places, such as the notes about a person and the colours.	Some

The search box and the **+** button are along the top of every screen. A back arrow at the top left takes you back one screen.

> If a page says Select a person or No person selected, it needs a person first. Search for someone, then open them. A page says no person is selected (page 34) shows how.

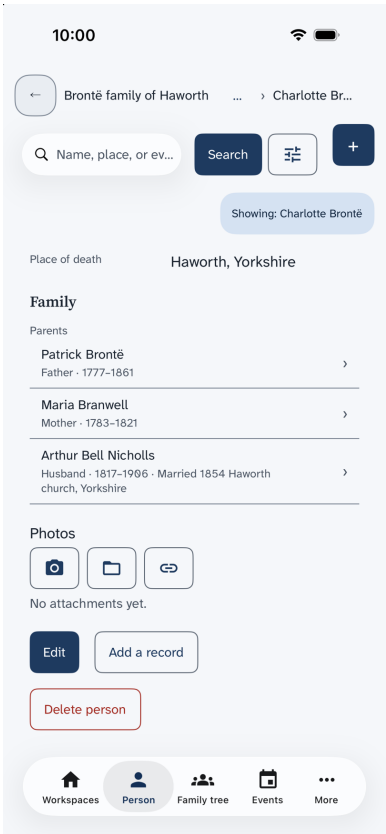
Workspaces

This is the first screen. Each card is one family tree. It tells you how many people, families and events the tree holds. Remove a tree from the list (page 39) starts here.



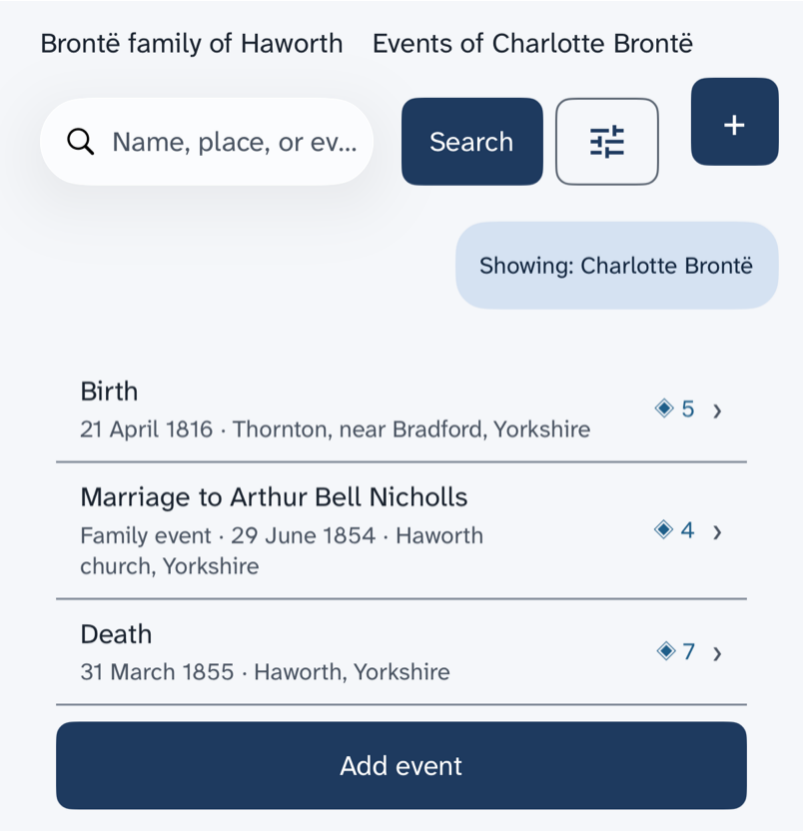
Person

This is one person's page: their names, their birth and death, their family and their photos. Find a person (page 16) shows how to open it.



Family tree and Events

See a family tree (page 18) explains the tree. See the events of a person (page 20) explains the list of events.

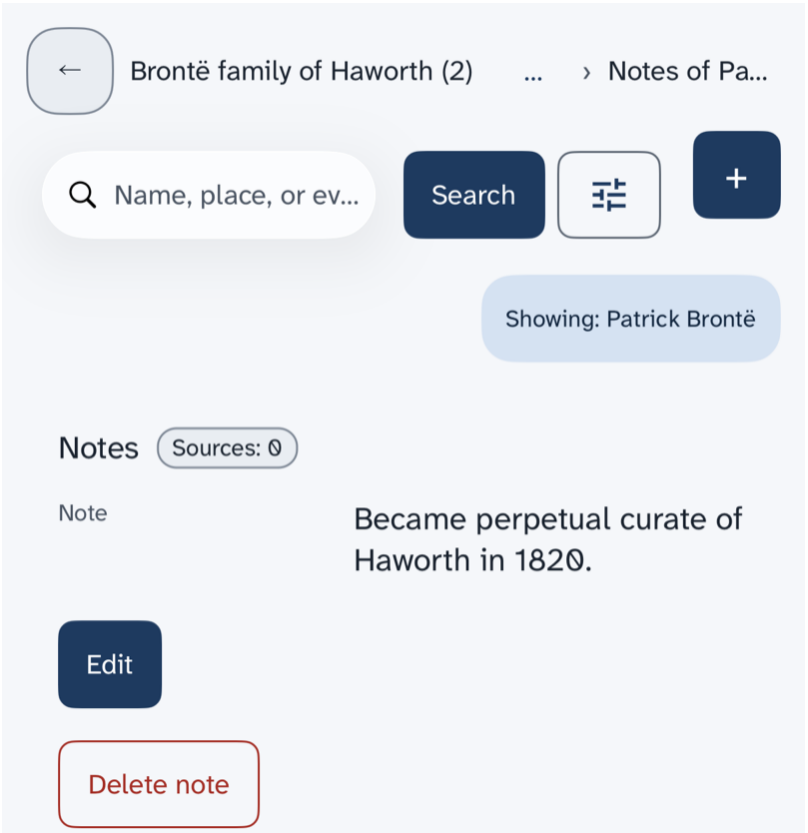


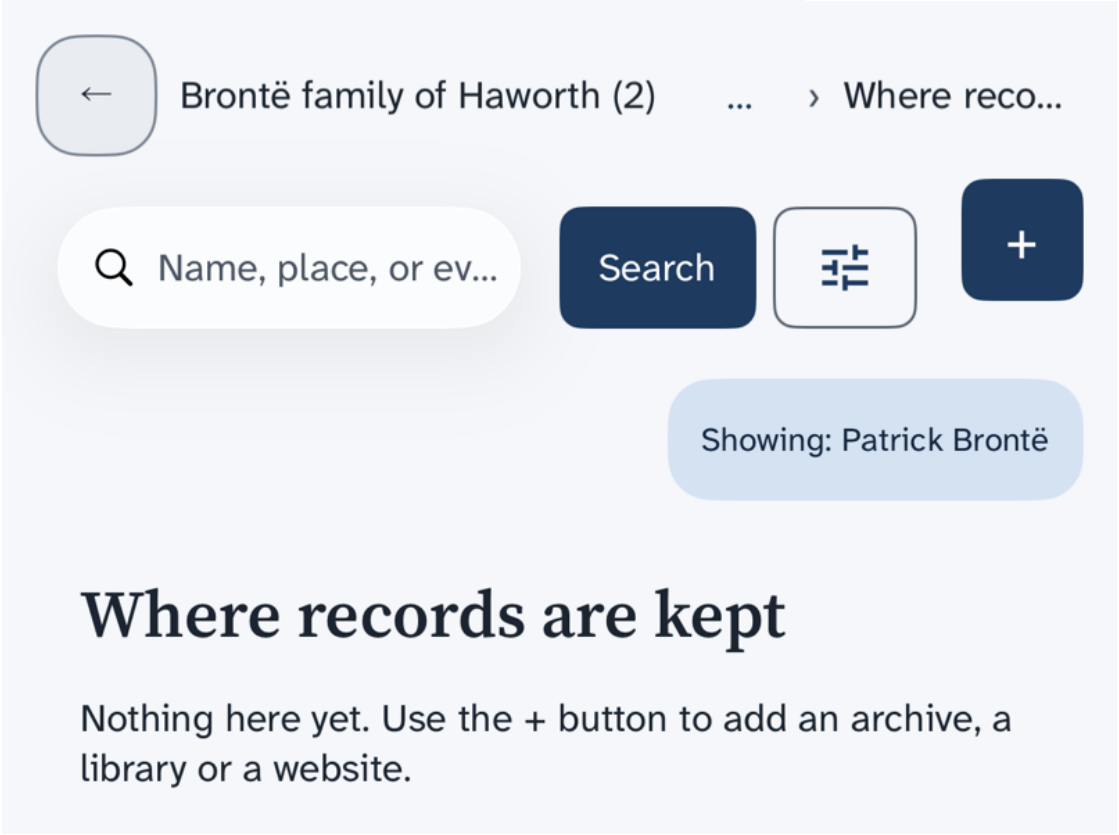
The More list

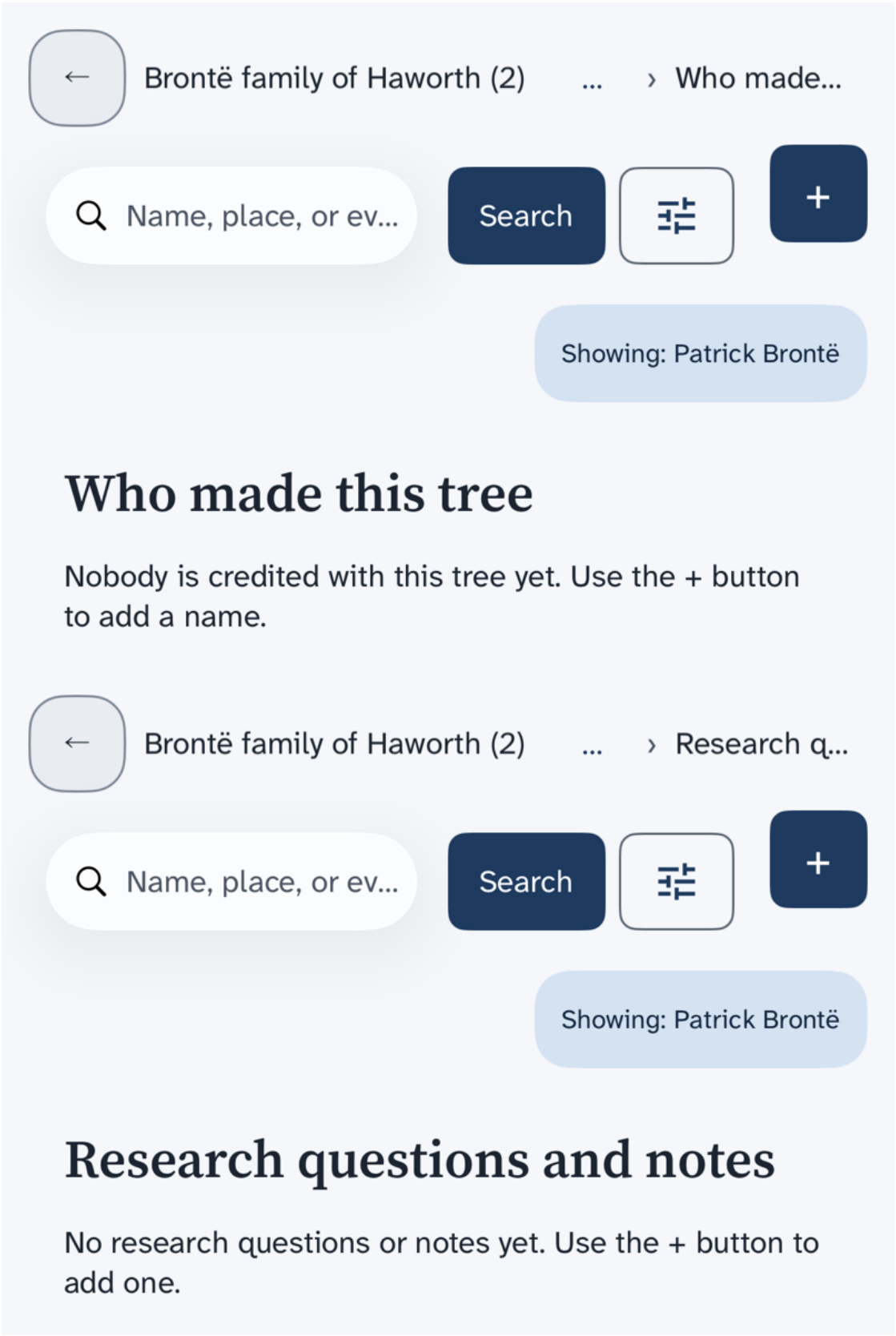
Choose **More** to see six places. Each one opens a screen of its own.

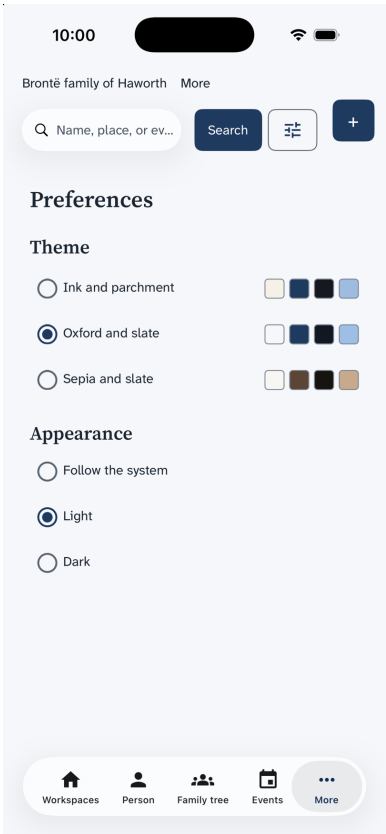
- **Notes** shows your own notes about the person you are looking at. Add a note to a person (page 31) shows how to write one.
- **Where records are kept** lists the archives, libraries and websites that your sources come from.
- **Who made this tree** lists the people credited with the tree.
- **Research questions and notes** is your list of questions and ideas.
- **Preferences** sets the colours and the light or dark look. Choose how the app looks (page 33) explains it.
- **About uFTi** shows the version of the app.

The three that list things for the whole tree are empty until you add something with **+**.


Brontë family of Haworth (2) ... › Notes of Pa...
Name, place, or ev...
Search
Showing: Patrick Brontë
Notes
Sources: 0
Note
Became perpetual curate of Haworth in 1820.
Edit
Delete note


Brontë family of Haworth (2) ... › Where reco...
Name, place, or ev...
Search
Showing: Patrick Brontë
Where records are kept
Nothing here yet. Use the + button to add an archive, a library or a website.


Brontë family of Haworth (2) ... › Who made...
Name, place, or ev...
Search
Showing: Patrick Brontë
Who made this tree
Nobody is credited with this tree yet. Use the + button to add a name.
Brontë family of Haworth (2) ... › Research q...
Name, place, or ev...
Search
Showing: Patrick Brontë
Research questions and notes
No research questions or notes yet. Use the + button to add one.



Find a person

Search your tree by a name, a place or an event, then open the person you want.

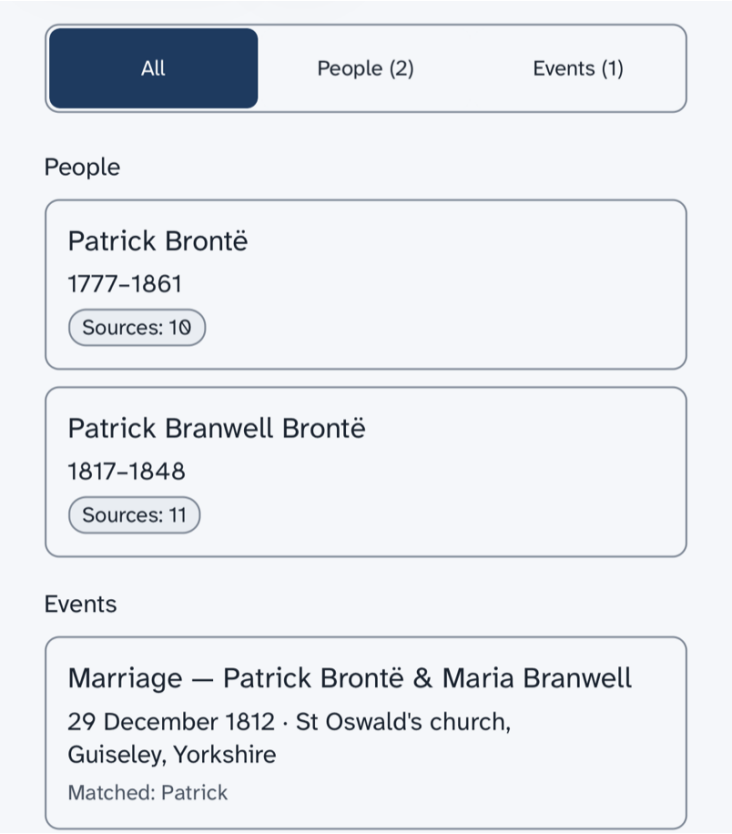
The search box is at the top of every screen. It searches the tree that is open. There is no list of all your people: search is how you find one.

1. Type a name, a place or an event in the box at the top.

   For example, type `Patrick`.

2. Choose **Search**.

   The results come in one list. The people come first. The events come after them. A small badge on each person, such as Sources: 10, says how many sources back that person up.

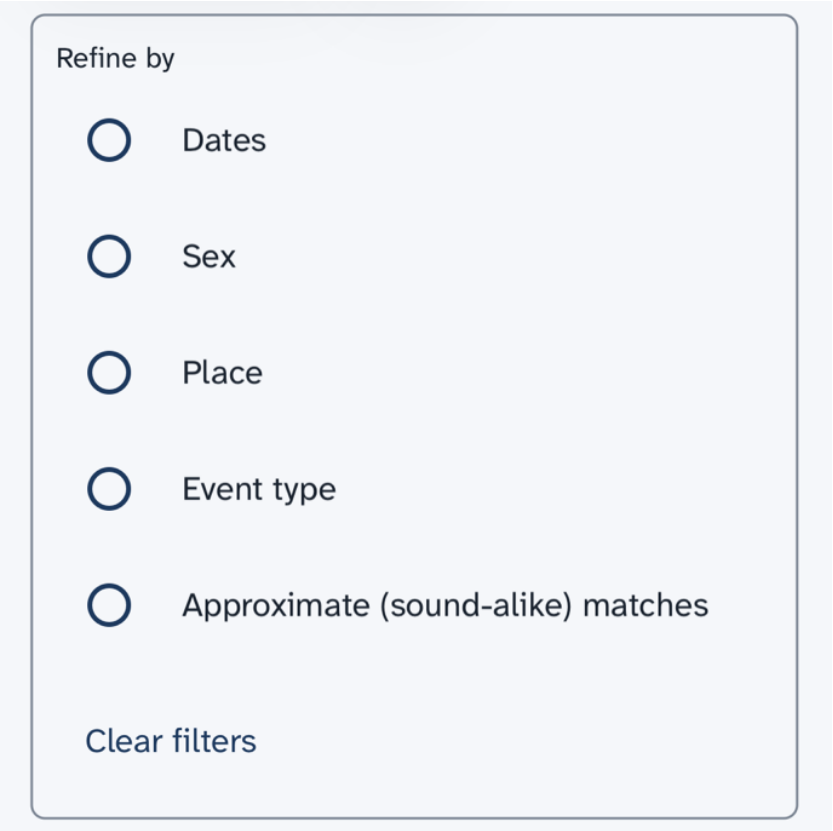


3. Choose the card of the person you want.
   The page of that person opens. Their name shows in the chip that starts with **Showing**.

Now **Family tree**, **Events** and **Notes** all show that person.

Three buttons above the cards show everything, only the people, or only the events.

To narrow the results, choose the button with the sliders next to **Search**. A list named **Refine by** opens. Tick **Dates**, **Sex**, **Place** or **Event type** to add a filter. Tick **Approximate (sound-alike) matches** to also find names that sound alike. Choose **Clear filters** to start again.



Next: See a family tree (page 18).

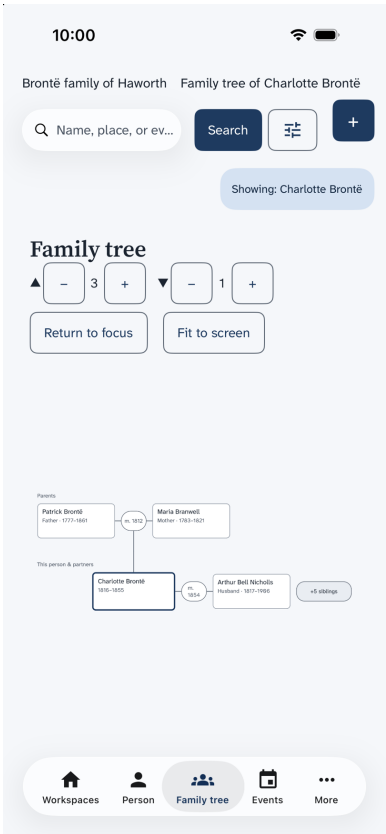
See a family tree

Draw the parents, partners and children of one person.

Open a person first. Find a person (page 16) shows how.

1. Choose **Family tree** in the bar along the bottom.

   A drawing opens, with the person you chose in a box with a dark edge. Their parents are above. Their partners are beside them. Their children are below. The boxes are small, so the drawing is easiest to read when you choose **Fit to screen** first.



2. Choose the round mark between two partners.

   The mark shows the year of their marriage. A sheet opens from the bottom. It names the couple and lists their marriage and each child.



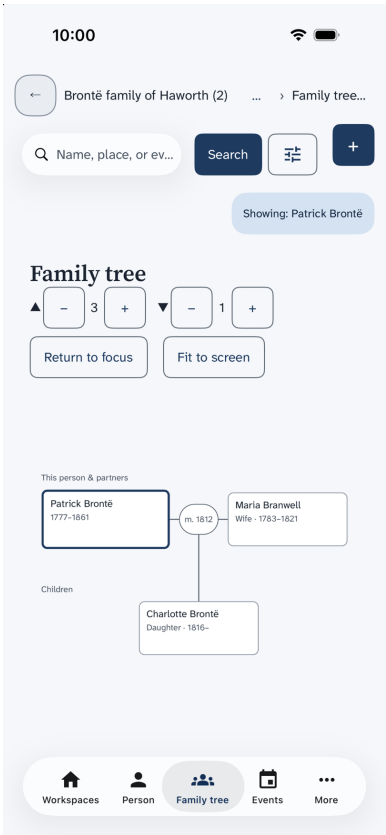
3. Choose a line in the sheet.

   The marriage line opens the page of that family. A child's line shows the tree of that child. Open family record is another way to open the family page.

4. Use the minus and plus buttons at the top to show fewer or more generations.

   The pair beside the up arrow is for parents and older people. The pair beside the down arrow is for children and younger people.

Choose **Return to focus** to go back to the first person. Choose **Fit to screen** to see the whole drawing at once. A button such as +5 siblings means more brothers and sisters are not drawn.



The same tree is the pedigree in older manuals. Next: See the events of a person (page 20).

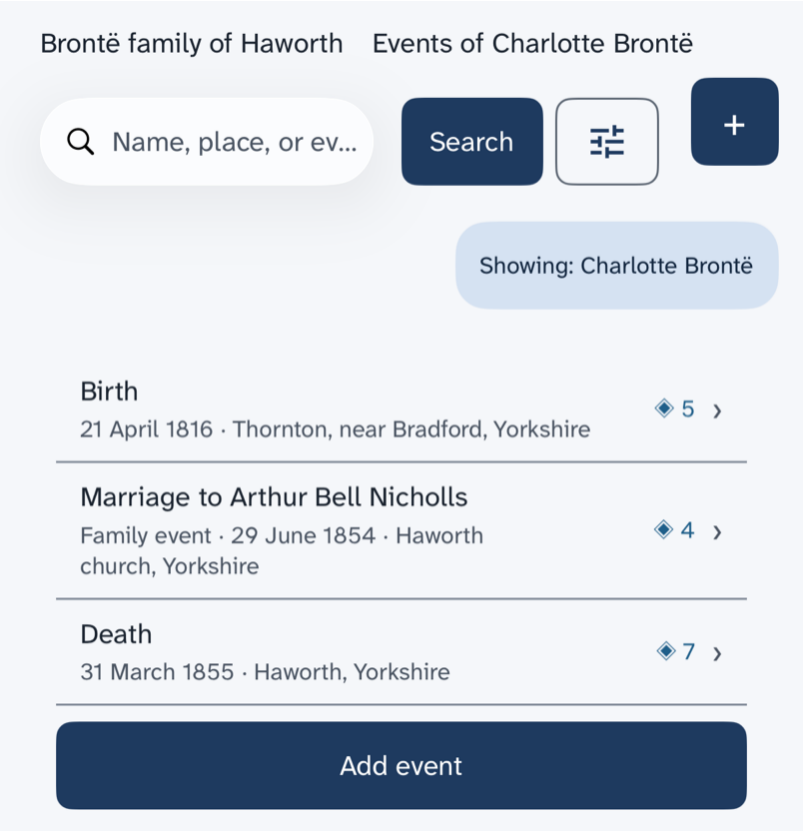
See the events of a person

List what happened in a person's life, such as birth, marriage and death, and open any one.

Open a person first. Find a person (page 16) shows how.

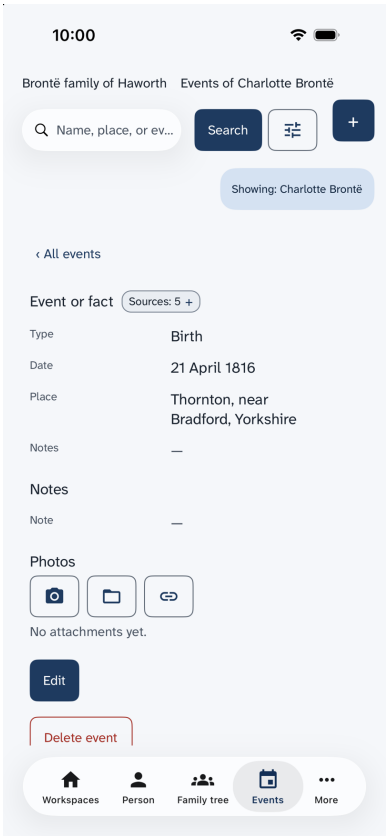
1. Choose **Events** in the bar along the bottom.

   Each event has a line with its name, its date and its place. A small number at the right counts the sources for it.



2. Choose an event to open it.

   A page shows its type, date and place. It has a count of sources, a row of photo buttons, and the buttons **Edit** and **Delete event**.



3. Choose **All events** at the top to go back to the list.

To add an event, choose **Add event** under the list.

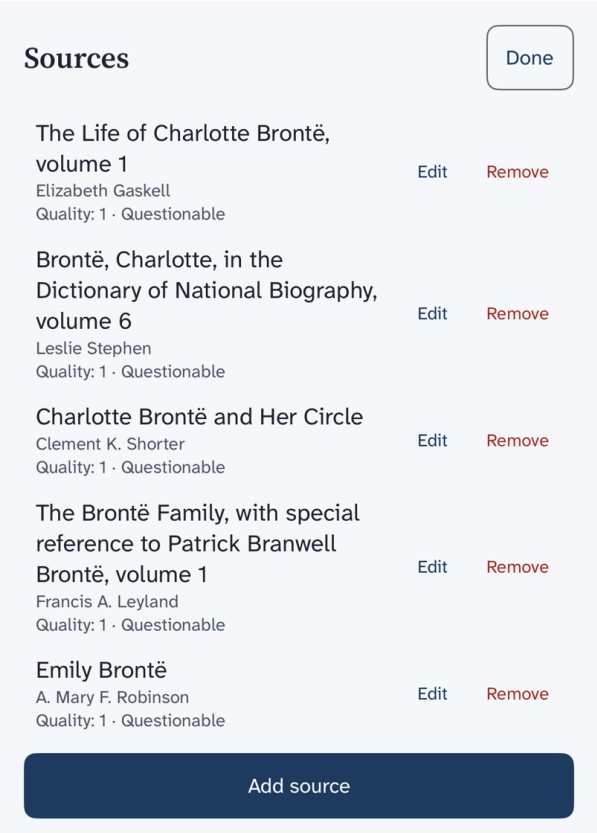
Next: Look at the sources of a fact (page 22).

Look at the sources of a fact

See which books and records back up a birth, a death or another fact, and change or remove one.

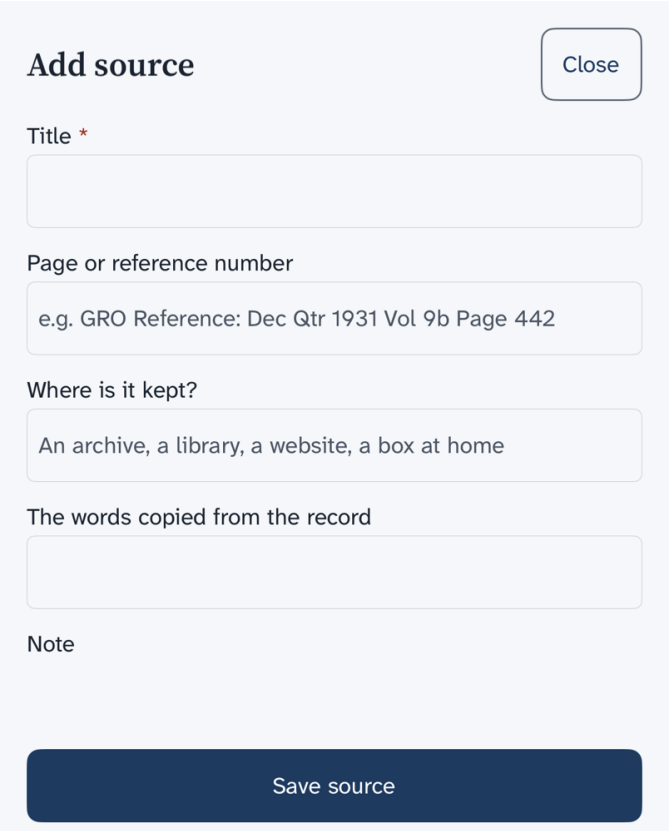
Each fact on a person's page has a small chip that counts its sources. A chip that says Sources: 0 means nothing backs that fact up yet. Every count of sources uses the same words, so you see them on a person's card in search results and on the Notes screen too.

1. On the page of a person, choose the chip beside **Birth**.
   A screen named **Sources** opens. Each source shows its title, its author and a quality line.

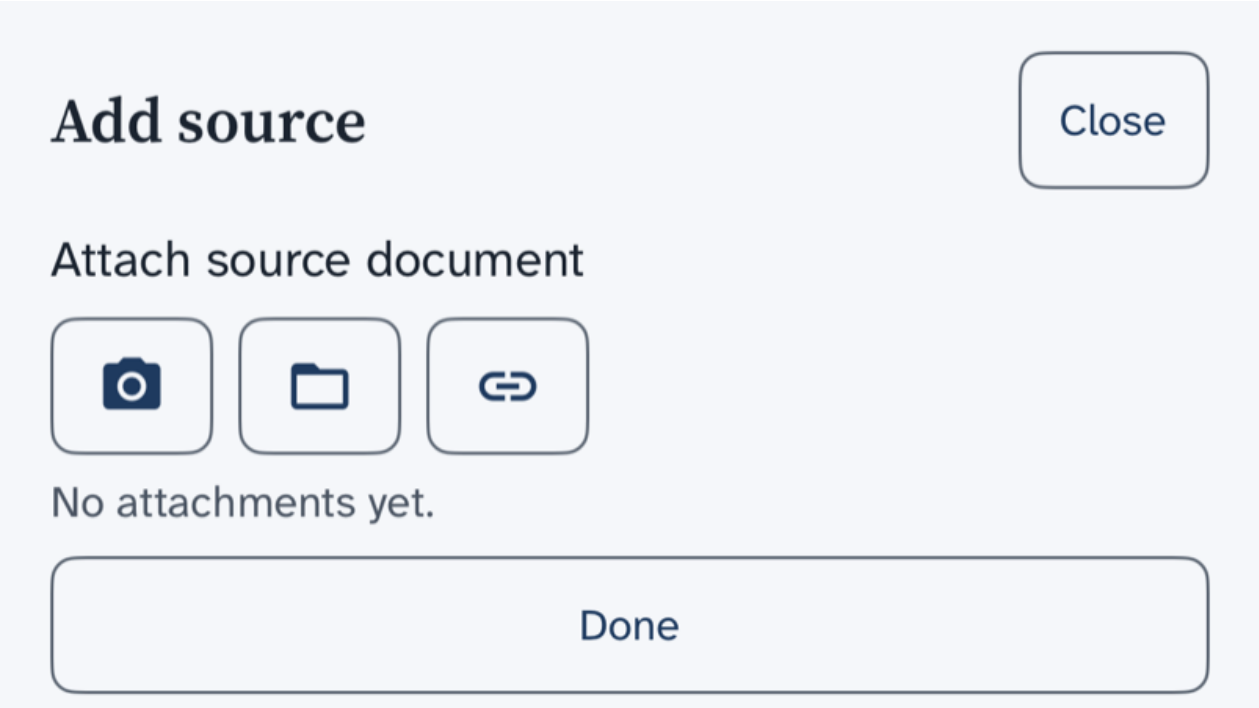


2. Choose **Edit** beside a source to change it.
   A form opens with the title and the other details. Choose **Save source** to keep your change.

3. Choose **Remove** beside a source to take it off this fact.
4. To add a source, choose **Add source**, then **Add a new source**.
   A form opens. It has boxes for the title, the page, where the source is kept, the words copied from it and a note. Only the title is needed.



5. Type the title, then choose **Save source**.
   One more step offers to attach a copy of the source. You can skip it.



6. Choose **Done**.
   The list now shows the new source.



7. Choose **Done** again when you have finished.

You are back on the page of the person. The chip shows the new count.

A fact with no source shows the words No sources for this fact yet. and the button **Add source**. Under it, **Compare records that disagree** is for two records that give different answers. The button is not there once the fact has a source.



The screen that opens from **Add source** also has a box to search for a source you have already added. Use it when one book backs up many facts.

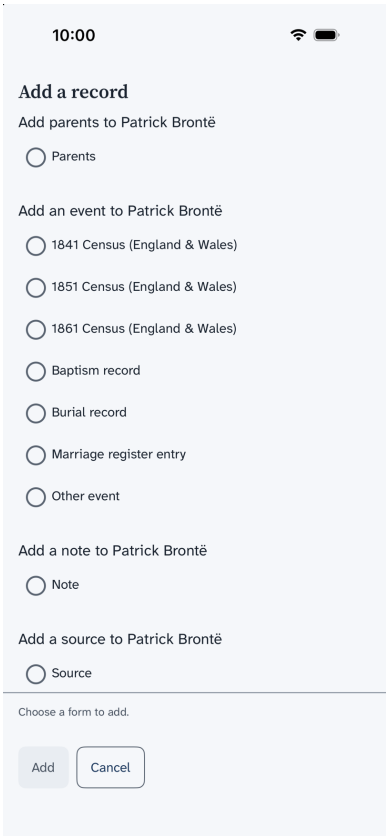
Next: Add another person (page 25).

Add another person

Add a person to a tree that already has someone in it.

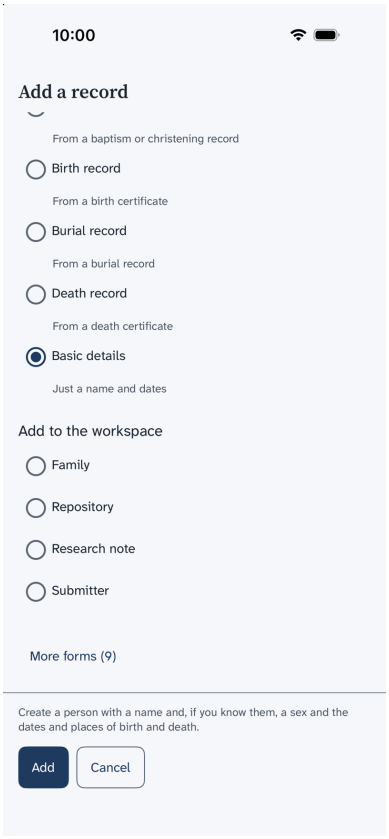
The first person comes with a new tree. After that, you add people with **+**.

1. Choose **+** at the top right.
   A sheet named **Add a record** fills the screen. If a person is open, it starts with things you can add to that person.



2. Scroll down to the part named **Add a new person**.
3. Choose **Basic details**, then choose **Add** at the bottom.
   The button stays grey until you choose a form.

   The **New person** form opens.



4. Type the names, choose the sex and add the dates and places you know.

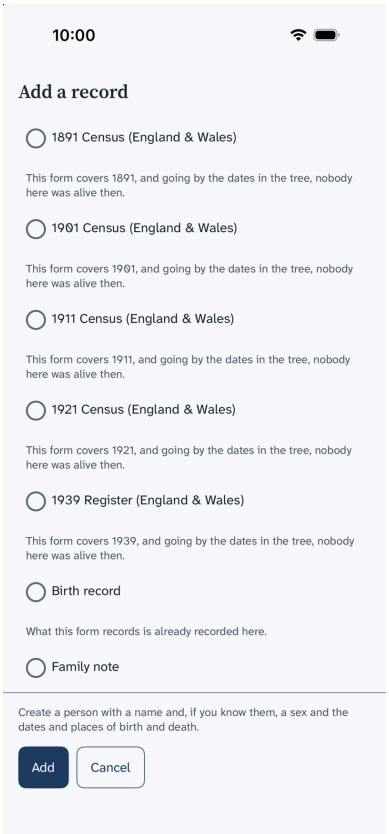
   Only **Given name(s)** is needed. For a date, type the day and the year and choose the month from the list. A line under the date says how the app reads it, such as Reads as 17 March 1777.

5. Scroll to the bottom of the form and choose **Save**.

   You go back to the screen you came from. The new person is in your tree.

To open the new person, Find a person (page 16).

The sheet ends with **More forms**, with a count in brackets. Choose it to see the forms that do not fit this person. Each one has a line under it that says why. For example, This form covers 1891, and going by the dates in the tree, nobody here was alive then.



Next: Add a family with children (page 28).

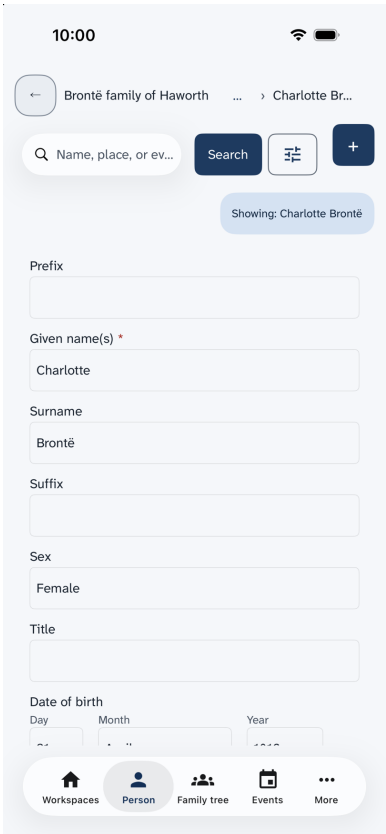
Change a person

Correct a name, a date or a place on a person's page.

Open the person first. Find a person (page 16) shows how.

1. Scroll to the bottom of the page and choose **Edit**.

   The page turns into a form. It holds the names, the sex, and the dates and places of birth and death. The form may open part of the way down: scroll up to see the top.



2. Change what is wrong.
3. Scroll to the bottom of the form. Choose **Save** to keep your changes, or **Cancel** to leave the form as it was.

Your changes are saved to the file as you go. The page shows the new words.

> The button **Delete person** sits below **Edit**. It removes the person. Check before you choose it.

Next: Look at the sources of a fact (page 22).

Add a family with children

Join two partners, record their marriage and add their children.

Add both partners first. Add another person (page 25) shows how.

1. Open one of the partners, scroll down and choose **Add a new family**. Then choose **Add**.

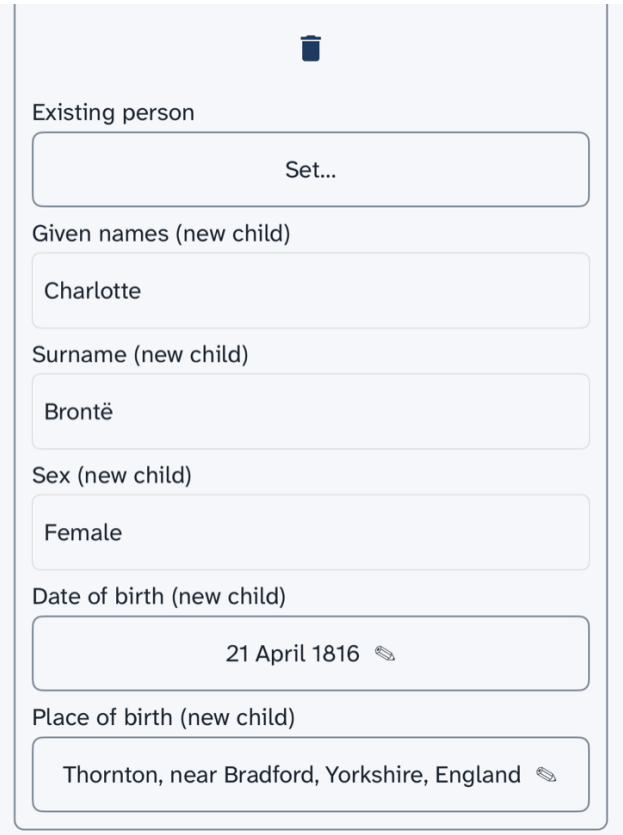
   A person who is not in a family yet shows this button under **Family**. The sheet that opens has the choice Family ticked for you.

   A form opens. The person you came from is already in one of the partner boxes.

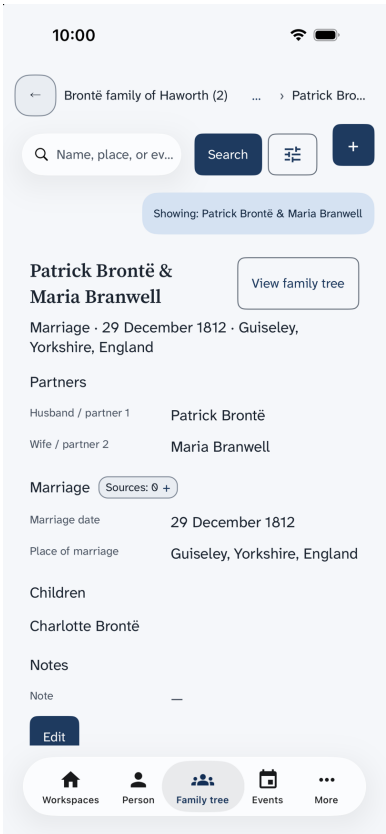
2. Select the other partner's box and type the name.

   A short list of people appears under the box.

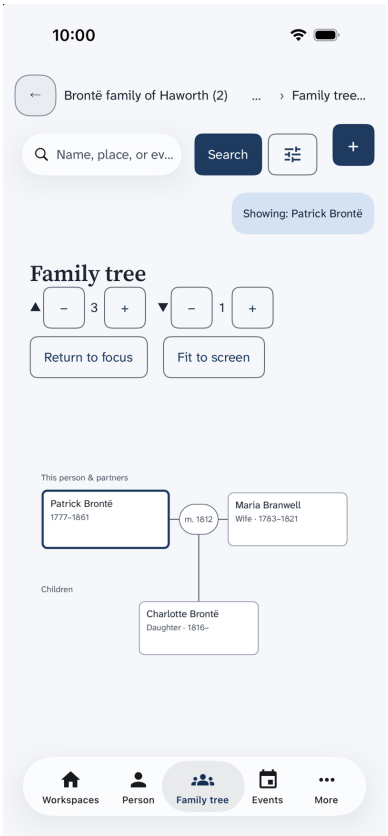
3. Choose the person from the list.
   The name only counts once you choose it from the list.
4. Scroll down and fill in **Marriage date** and **Place of marriage**.
   Leave them empty if you do not know them.
5. Under **Children**, choose **Add row**.
   A card appears for one child, with boxes for the names and the sex.
6. Type the child's names and choose the sex. Then choose **Set...** for the birth date and for the birthplace.
   A small window opens for each. Fill it in and choose **Done**. The button then shows what you typed.



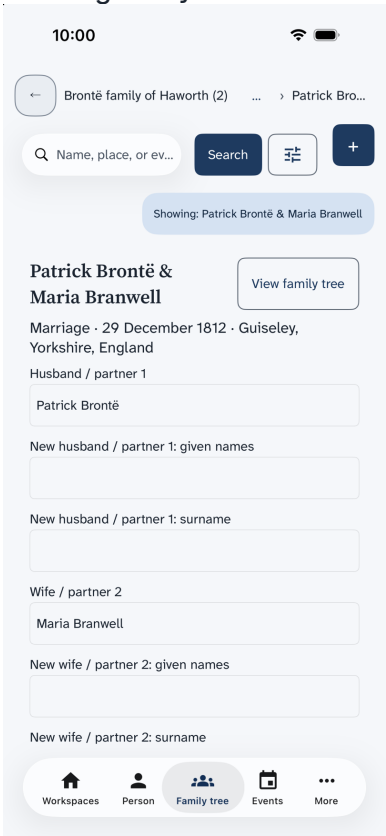
7. Scroll to the bottom and choose **Save**.
   The page of the family opens. It lists the partners, the marriage and the children.



Choose **View family tree** to see the family drawn out.



To change a family later, choose **Edit** on its page. The form shows the partners and the marriage as you saved them.



The page of the family also has **Delete family**. Next: Add a note to a person (page 31).

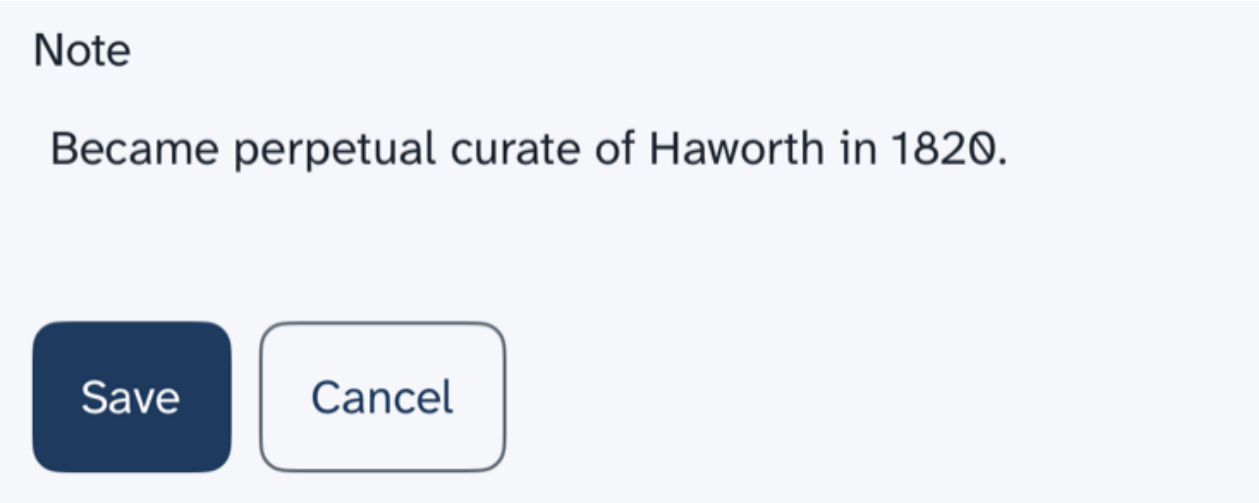
Add a note to a person

Write down something you know about a person that does not fit in a date or a place.

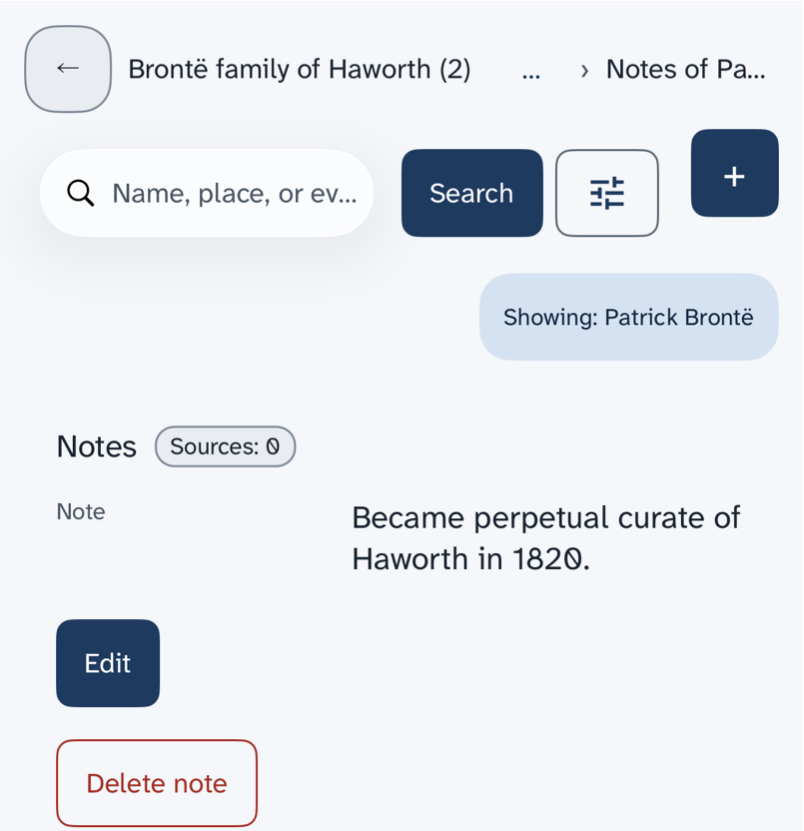
Open the person first. Find a person (page 16) shows how.

1. Choose **+** at the top right.
   The sheet named **Add a record** opens.
2. Choose **Note** under the part for a note, then choose **Add** at the bottom.
   Scroll the sheet to find the part.

   A form opens with one box for the note.



3. Type your note, then choose **Save**.
4. Choose **More** in the bar along the bottom, then **Notes**.
   The note shows under **Notes**, with **Edit** and a button to delete it.



The note belongs to that person. Write what you know. Say where you read it if you can.

Next: Choose how the app looks (page 33).

The Photos buttons

What the buttons under Photos are for on a person, an event or a source.

A person's page, an event and a source each have a part named **Photos**. It has three round-cornered buttons in a row. Under them, the page says No attachments yet until you add a picture.

The same three buttons appear when you attach a copy of a source. Which file to send (page 40) says which file to send to family, and whether the pictures go with it.

The camera button

The first button has a camera on it. It is for a new photo, such as a photo of a certificate.

The first time, the iPhone asks if uFTi may use the camera. Choose **Allow** to take photos in the app.

The folder button

The second button has a folder on it. It is for a picture or a scan that is already on your iPhone. The iPhone's own Files screen opens. Choose a picture, or choose the cross at the top to leave it.

The chain button

The third button has a chain link on it. It is for a picture that is already in this tree, so you can use it again on a second person. A list named Link existing media opens, with a box to search the pictures by what they show. A new tree has none yet. Choose **Close** to leave it.

The fourth button

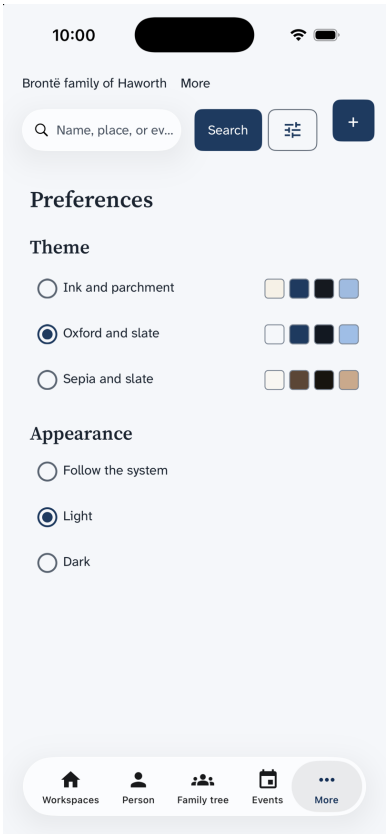
When a page already has pictures, a fourth button shows, with an arrow that points down. It copies all the pictures of that page to a folder. The iPhone's own screen for choosing a folder opens.

Choose how the app looks

Pick a colour theme, and a light or dark look, for this iPhone.

These settings are for this iPhone only. They do not change your family tree files.

1. Choose **More** in the bar along the bottom, then **Preferences**.
   The screen shows two groups of choices.



2. Under **Theme**, choose a set of colours.

   The first group has three themes, and a row of four colour squares shows each one. **Oxford and slate** is the one in the pictures in this manual.

3. Under **Appearance**, choose **Follow the system**, **Light** or **Dark**.

   The first choice copies the setting you made on your iPhone.

The change shows at once. The app keeps your choice the next time you open it.

A page says no person is selected

What to do when Family tree asks you to pick a person first, or Person, Events and Notes show only the search box.

You choose **Family tree** and the page says Select a person to view their family tree. Or you choose **Person**, **Events** or **Notes** and the page is empty under the search box.

Cause

These pages show one person at a time. You have not opened anyone since the app started. There is no chip that starts with **Showing** at the top.

Remedy

1. Type a name in the search box at the top, then choose **Search**.
2. Choose the card of the person you want.

   The chip that starts with **Showing** shows their name. The page now works.

Cause

The page is empty because nothing has been added to the tree yet. **Where records are kept**, **Who made this tree** and **Research questions and notes** start empty.

Remedy

Choose **+** and add the first one.

Bring in, share and keep safe

What your workspace holds, why a GEDZIP file is the one to keep and send, and when a plain family tree file is better.

Your tree is more than one file. It is the family tree, its research notes, and the pictures and other files you attach. This chapter says what uFTi does with a file you open, how to keep a copy safe, and which file to send.

The short answer is the GEDZIP file. It holds your whole workspace in one file. Keep your work in a GEDZIP file, and send a GEDZIP file to anyone who also uses uFTi.

A plain family tree file is for older programs only. It leaves out your pictures and other attached files.

Your tree may have started in another program. Your family may want a copy. This chapter is for both.

Your workspace and its files

A workspace is your family tree and its linked files, and a GEDZIP file holds all of them in one file.

A workspace is one family tree and everything kept with it. That is the family tree file, with its research notes, and the pictures and other files you attach to people, facts and sources.

Linked files

The family tree file does not hold your pictures. It links to them, and the pictures stay in files of their own. The same is true of other attached files.

So if you send only the family tree file, the other person gets the tree and its links, but not the pictures.

One file for the whole workspace

A GEDZIP file puts the family tree file and all the files linked to it into one file. You send one file, and nothing is left behind. Another person who uses uFTi opens it and sees your whole workspace.

For that reason, a GEDZIP file is the one to keep and the one to share between copies of uFTi.

The plain family tree file

A plain family tree file holds the people, families, facts, sources and research notes. It does not hold the pictures or other attached files.

When you save one, uFTi asks which version of GEDCOM to use. Choose GEDCOM 7, which was published in 2021 and is the one it recommends. Choose GEDCOM 5.5.1, which was published in 1999, only for an older program that cannot read GEDCOM 7.

A GEDZIP file holds a GEDCOM 7 family tree file, with the pictures and other attached files beside it.

At a glance

Table 1. Which file holds what

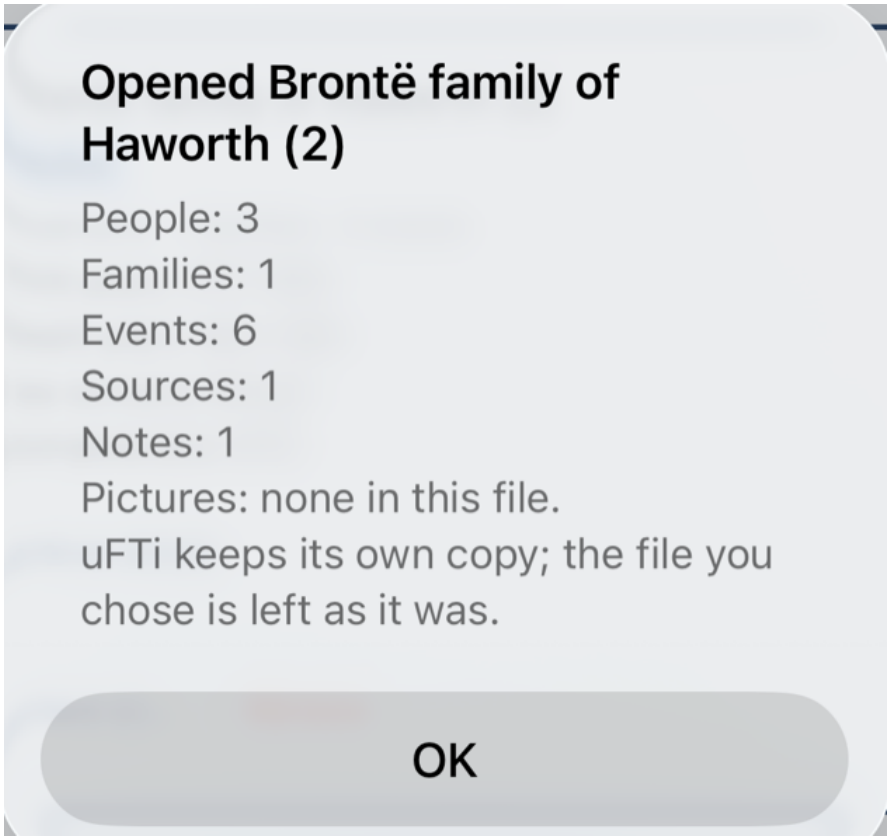
File	The tree and its research notes	Pictures and other attached files	Use it to
GEDZIP file	Yes	Yes	Keep your work, and share it with another copy of uFTi.
Plain family tree file	Yes	No	Share with another program that reads GEDCOM, or work with one.

Open a family tree file

Bring a tree from another program, or a copy from a relative, into uFTi.

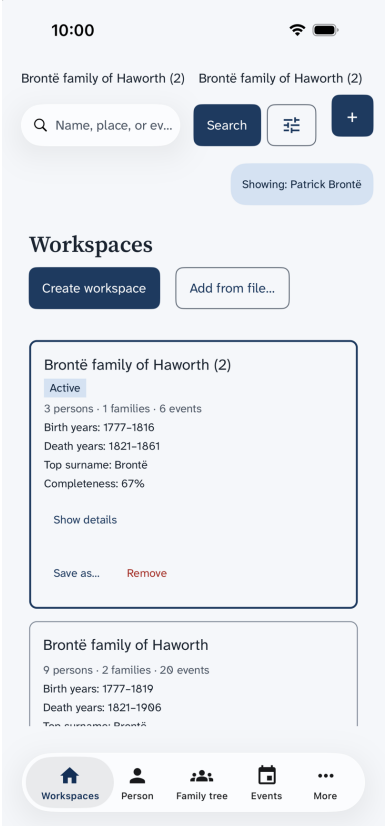
A family tree file ends in .ged or .gdz. Put the file on your iPhone first, for example in the Files app, under On My iPhone. uFTi works on its own copy, so the file you choose stays as it was. Opened files and copies (page 39) says more.

1. On **Workspaces**, choose **Add from file...**.
   The iPhone's own Files screen opens.
2. Find the file, for example under On My iPhone, and choose it.
   A box names the tree and counts the people, families, events, sources and notes in it. It says uFTi keeps its own copy; the file you chose is left as it was.



3. Choose **OK**.
   The tree has a new card on **Workspaces**.

The cards are one under another. Choose a card to make that tree the open one. Choose **Show details** on a card to see which file it is.



> A card takes its name from the file. If two cards have the same name, choose **Show details** on each to tell them apart.

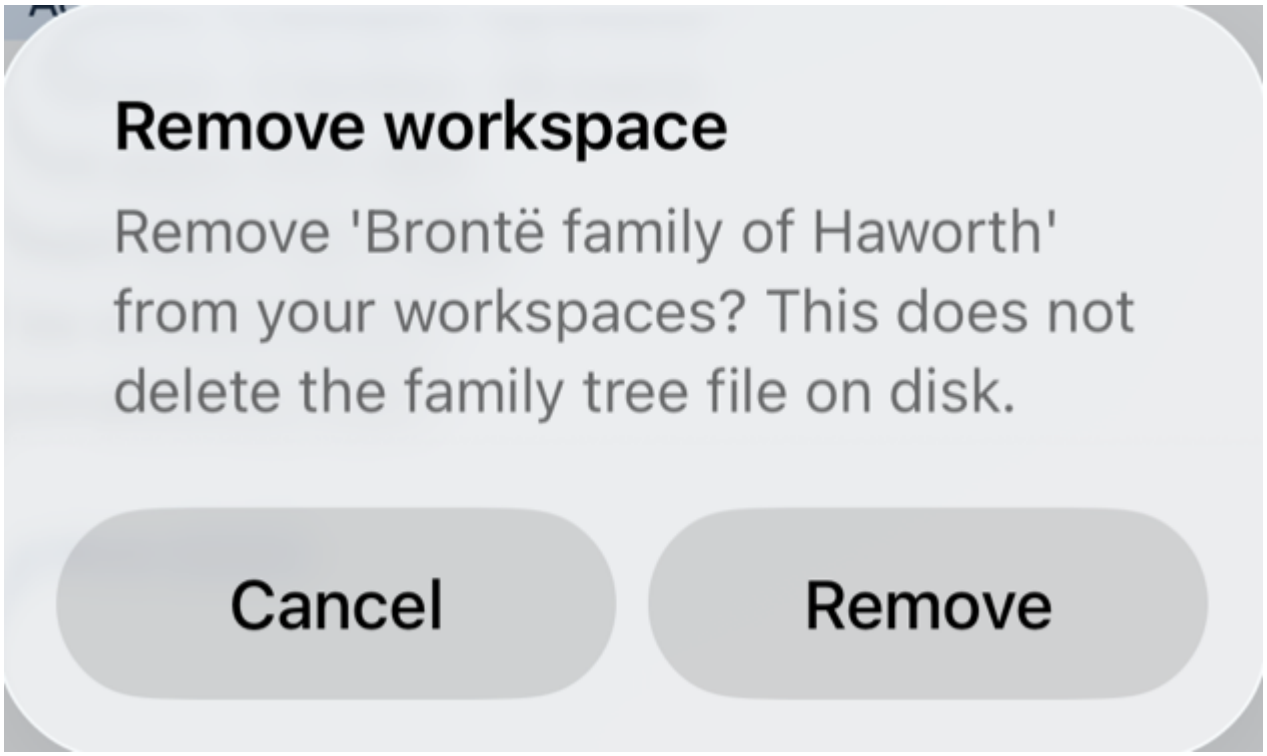
Next: Keep it safe (page 7).

Remove a tree from the list

Take a tree off the Workspaces screen without deleting its file.

1. On **Workspaces**, find the card of the tree.
2. Choose **Remove** on that card.

   A box named Remove workspace asks you to check. It says the family tree file is not deleted.



3. Choose **Remove** in the box, or **Cancel** to stop.

The card is gone, and a line at the bottom says the tree was removed. The file is still on your iPhone. Open it again with **Add from file…** at any time.

Opened files and copies

On a phone or tablet, uFTi works on its own copy of the file you choose, so the file you chose stays as it was.

When you choose a family tree file, uFTi gets a copy of it and keeps the copy as its own. When the file opens, uFTi says so in one line. It works on that copy, so the file you chose does not change.

The file you chose

The file you chose stays as it was, however much you add. That also means it does not show your new work.

Get your tree out

The copy that uFTi works on is not a file you can pick up and send. To get your tree out, choose **Save as...** on the card for your tree. Then choose how to save it, and where to put the file. Choose the GEDZIP file, unless you need a plain family tree file for an older program.

The file you save is a saved copy. It stays as it was when you made it. Make a new one after you add a lot.

Sending your tree

Send a GEDZIP copy that you saved. Which file to send (page 40) says why.

Which file to send

Send a GEDZIP file to anyone who uses uFTi, and a plain family tree file only to an older program.

To share your tree with someone who uses uFTi, save a copy as a GEDZIP file with **Save as...** , and send that file. Keep it safe (page 7) shows how to make one.

A GEDZIP file holds your whole workspace: the tree, its research notes, and the pictures and other attached files. It is one file, so you can send it from your phone or tablet. Nothing is left behind, so the other person sees what you see. Your workspace and its files (page 36) says more.

For an older program

Some older programs cannot read a GEDZIP file. For them, save a plain family tree file instead. It holds the people, families, facts, sources and research notes, but not the pictures or other attached files. If the other person needs the pictures, send them as well.

Do not send the file you chose

Do not send the file you chose when you opened your tree. uFTi did not change it, so it does not show your new work. The copy that uFTi works on is not a file you can send.

A saved copy stays as it was when you made it. Make a new one before you send, if you have added anything since.

Glossary

B F G P S W

B

backup

An older copy of your family tree file, which the app makes for you. It is made the first time the app saves after you start it.

F

fact

Something you record about a person, such as a birth with its date and place.

family tree file

A GEDCOM file that holds a whole family tree, with its people, families, facts, sources and research notes. It does not hold pictures or other attached files. You can open one, save one and send one.

G

GEDCOM

The standard format for family tree files. Many family tree programs read it. GEDCOM 5.5.1 was published in 1999. It has been the common format for more than twenty years. GEDCOM 7, published in 2021, is the newer version. A version belongs to the standard, not to uFTi.

GEDZIP

One file that holds a whole workspace. It has the family tree with its research notes, and the pictures and other files. It is the best way to save and send your work.

P

pedigree

A family tree drawn for one person. It shows their parents above them, and their partners and children.

S

saved copy

A copy of your tree that you save yourself, as a GEDZIP file (preferred) or a family tree file. It stays as it was when you made it.

source

Where you found a fact. It can be a certificate, a census page, a book, or what someone told you.

W

workspace

One family tree and everything kept with it. That is the family tree file with its research notes, and the pictures and other files you attach. A GEDZIP file holds all of it. You can have more than one.